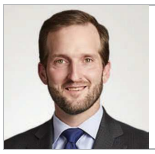
Artisan Focus Fund

QUARTERLY
Commentary

Investor Class: ARTTX | Advisor Class: APDTX | Institutional Class: APHTX

As of 30 June 2026



Portfolio Manager
Christopher Smith

"The most important investments often appear expensive long before they appear indispensable."

—Chris Smith, portfolio manager of the Antero Peak Group

Performance Review

Q2 was another strong one for the Antero Peak Group. The Artisan Focus Fund (ARTTX) appreciated 21.11% during the period, compared to a gain of 15.20% for the S&P 500® Index, increasing our year-to-date alpha to 6.35 percentage points. While we are pleased with our Q2 results, our focus remains on long-term capital appreciation and the fundamental progress of the businesses we own in the portfolio.

Exhibit 1: Investment Results

As of 30 Jun 2026	Q2 2026	YTD	Annualized (since inception)	Cumulative (since inception)
Artisan Focus Fund (Investor Class)	21.11%	16.56%	18.69%	382.42%
S&P 500® Index	15.20%	10.21%	15.22%	267.45%
Alpha (percentage points)	*5.91*	*6.35*	*3.47*	*114.97*
S&P 500® Equal Weight Index	11.39%	12.13%	11.80%	178.60%
Alpha (percentage points)	*9.72*	*4.42*	*6.90*	*203.83*

Source: Antero Peak Group/S&P. As of 30 Jun 2026. **Past performance does not guarantee and is not a reliable indicator of future results. Investment returns and principal values will fluctuate so that an investor's shares, when redeemed, may be worth more or less than their original cost. Current performance may be lower or higher than that shown. Call 800.344.1770 for current to most recent month-end performance.** Returns greater than one year are annualized unless otherwise noted. Fund inception: 24 Apr 2017.

We believe a defining characteristic of successful investing is the ability to understand the impact of change before it becomes consensus. We have long held the view that markets are very efficient when evaluating stable conditions, yet markets often become very inefficient when conditions change. Competitive positions shift, technologies move along S-curves, societal behaviors evolve, and legislation alters incentives. These developments can cause the future to look materially different than the past. We believe this dynamic is often most pronounced during major capital formation cycles, where short-term thinking can obscure the magnitude of longer term change.

Our process is designed, with an empirical and repeatable foundation, to direct our attention toward areas of the economy experiencing significant transformation. Major transitions create uncertainty, disagreement and, ultimately, opportunities for differentiated research. Rising returns on invested capital, accelerating fundamental revisions, expanding addressable markets and inflecting growth trajectories are often the tangible manifestations of underlying industry changes.

Whether measured through returns on invested capital, earnings power or shifts in growth expectations, we have repeatedly found that these factors have demonstrated a durable relationship with excess returns across decades, industries and economic cycles.

In this letter, we review quarterly performance and the evolving role of active and passive allocations and discuss the role major capital formation cycles have played throughout economic history and their relevance to today's investment landscape. Accordingly, we outline several updates to the thematic framework we use to categorize and discuss the portfolio. These changes reflect the evolution of the opportunity set while remaining consistent with the investment philosophy that has guided the portfolio since inception.

Quarter in Review

Q2 results were driven by company fundamentals rather than factor exposure or macro positioning.

The broader market entered the quarter with one of the strongest earnings environments in recent history. Historically, the S&P 500® Index's earnings estimates decline as the year progresses, falling approximately 2% to 3% on average over the past 20–40 quarters. This quarter was highly unusual. Instead of declining, consensus earnings estimates for the index increased 3.4%, representing one of the strongest quarterly revision environments in the last decade.

Against that backdrop, our portfolio companies continued to outperform fundamentally. Aggregate earnings estimates across the portfolio increased 4.6% during the quarter, extending a trend of positive revisions that has consistently underpinned our investment process.

Portfolio performance was also notably broad-based.

While technology remained an important contributor, returns were generated across multiple sectors and investment themes. Taiwan Semiconductor, Applied Materials, Analog Devices, NVIDIA, Astera Labs and Seagate contributed meaningfully as part of our Compute Infrastructure theme. Rolls-Royce and GE Aerospace continued to benefit from favorable aerospace fundamentals, Caterpillar participated in the ongoing expansion of domestic industrial investment, and Goldman Sachs generated strong returns as improving capital markets activity and expectations for regulatory reform supported financials.

Perhaps more important than the individual contributors were their diversity. Unlike the index, whose outperformance remained heavily concentrated in a small number of technology companies, our largest contributors spanned semiconductors, aerospace, industrials, machinery and financials. Industrials alone contributed approximately 6% to the portfolio's return during Q2 versus approximately 1% for the S&P 500® Index.

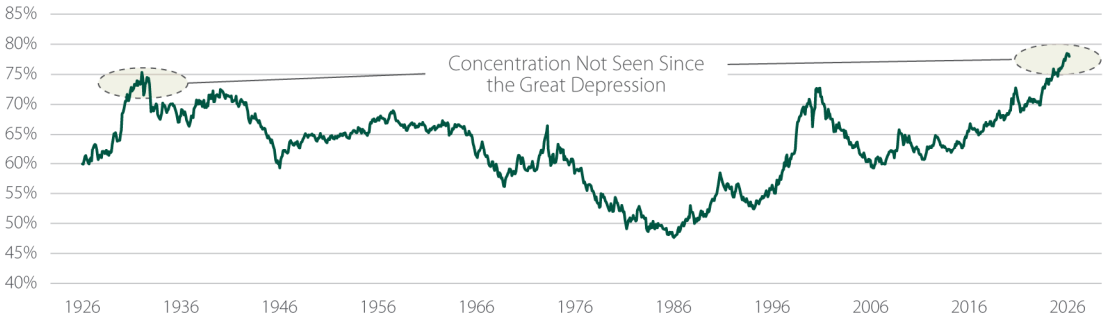
Headwinds were comparatively modest. The largest relative detractor was our limited exposure to a handful of exceptionally strong-performing technology companies, which collectively reduced relative performance by approximately 275bps. Micron was among the most significant individual detractors within this group.

Stepping back, we believe the quarter reinforced a lesson that has become increasingly evident over time. While markets are often driven by narratives over short periods, long-term returns continue to follow earnings. Despite geopolitical volatility and persistent macro uncertainty, businesses experiencing improving returns on capital, accelerating earnings revisions and strengthening competitive positions continued to outperform. We remain encouraged that these characteristics continue to define the majority of our portfolio.

Portfolio Construction in a Concentrated Index Environment

Index concentration has reached extreme levels. Today, the top decile of US equities represents approximately 80% of total market value, a level not seen since the Great Depression.

Exhibit 2: Index Concentration Is at Extreme Levels
Top 10% of US Companies' Percentage of Total Market Value



Source: French & Fama. As of 28 Feb 2026.

A natural conclusion is that index performance is increasingly dependent on a small number of securities. We do not attempt to solve for or position against this directly.

Since inception, our portfolio has been constructed entirely bottom up, independent of index weights and driven solely by company-level fundamentals. The only linkage to the index is through style factor exposure, not benchmark-relative positioning.

As a result, any divergence from index concentration is an emergent outcome of the underlying research process rather than an explicit construction objective. What is more important is what the process produces.

Since inception, the portfolio has delivered higher returns than the S&P 500® Index (382% versus 267%), while exhibiting lower dependence on the index's largest constituents, as reflected in a materially lower R^2 (0.77 versus 0.91).

Exhibit 3: The Portfolio Has Generated Higher Returns With Lower Dependence on the Largest Stocks

Since Inception (As of 30 Jun 2026)	**S&P 500® Index**	**Artisan Focus Fund (ARTTX)**
Cumulative Total Return	267.45%	382.42%
Alpha vs. S&P 500® Index	—	114.97%
R^2 vs. S&P 500® Top 20 Index	0.91	0.77
Forward Fundamentals		
ROIC (Year-End 2025)	10%	17%
EPS Growth Estimate, Three-Year	68%	88%

Source: Artisan Partners/S&P. As of 30 Jun 2026. Investor Class Fund inception: 24 Apr 2017. **Past performance does not guarantee and is not a reliable indicator of future results. Current performance may be lower or higher than performance shown.** Forward fundamentals based on the Artisan Focus Fund: Investor Class. S&P 500® Top 20 Index is shown for illustrative purposes only and is not a benchmark of the portfolio. S&P 500® Top 20 Index inception: 1 Aug 2024. All information for the Top 20 Index prior to its inception date is hypothetical back-tested, not actual performance, based on the index methodology in effect on the inception date. See Notes & Disclosures for additional information. Total earnings growth projections are estimates based on the team's analysis and subject to material revision. Earnings growth does not guarantee positive performance or outperformance. Three-year EPS growth estimate of 68% for the S&P 500® Index comprised of the compounded yearly estimates for 2026–2028: 2026: 24%; 2027: 17%; 2028: 16%. Three-year EPS growth estimate of 88% for the portfolio comprised of the compounded yearly estimates for 2026–2028: 2026: 38%; 2027: 23%; 2028: 12%.

Looking forward through year-end 2028, we believe the portfolio is positioned to generate meaningfully stronger fundamental outcomes versus the index, including higher and expanding average return on invested capital (approximately 17% to 22% versus 10% to 10%) and faster earnings growth (approximately 88% versus 68%). These figures represent forward expectations based on current portfolio composition and consensus aggregation.

We believe this distinction is important in the current market environment. *As index returns become increasingly driven by a small subset of securities, most portfolios tend to inherit those exposures implicitly through benchmark-relative construction. Our process does not. It aggregates independent, bottom-up assessments of individual companies undergoing change, which has resulted in a materially different pattern of exposure over time.*

The Interplay of Active and Passive Investing

We believe it is also important to acknowledge the role of passive investing in today's market structure. Passive strategies have been highly effective for investors over long periods of time, offering low-cost exposure to strong long-term results over many market cycles.

However, by design, passive ownership of a market-capitalization-weighted index such as the S&P 500® Index can result in meaningful exposure concentration. A significant portion of the index's returns and risk is currently being driven by a relatively small number of large companies, meaning that the experience of owning the index is increasingly shaped by a narrow set of securities.

We do not view this as a flaw in passive investing. Rather, it is a natural consequence of market-capitalization weighting in an environment where a small number of companies have delivered exceptional fundamental performance. Nevertheless, this dynamic may be relevant when evaluating the index's underlying sources of risk and return.

The portfolio has historically differed meaningfully from the S&P 500® Index in both its holdings and portfolio construction. The portfolio reflects the team's active, bottom-up investment process, which seeks to identify companies experiencing improving fundamentals, rising returns on capital and accelerating earnings growth ahead of broader market recognition.

The portfolio's differentiated positioning has historically resulted in sources of risk and return that vary from those of the S&P 500® Index. Although the portfolio itself is concentrated, that concentration has often been in companies and investment opportunities that differ from the index's largest constituents. As a result, the portfolio has generally had less exposure to certain of the index's largest constituents while assuming greater company-specific risk through its concentrated structure and active security selection.

In this context, active management is designed to provide differentiated exposures and return drivers relative to a market-capitalization-weighted index.

Historical Examination of Capital Formation Cycles

Economic history is, in many respects, the history of capital formation.

Railroads, electrification, interstate highways, commercial aviation, telecommunications networks and the Internet all required enormous capital investment before their economic value became fully apparent. While the technologies differed, the pattern was often similar. Capital spending accelerated rapidly, investors questioned whether the investment was excessive, and the resulting infrastructure ultimately proved indispensable.

The scale of these cycles is often underappreciated. Research examining major capital formation cycles over the last 150 years found that many reached 1%–2% of GDP at their peak. Some estimates suggest the current cycle could ultimately reach approximately 5% of GDP over the next several years. At 5% of today's GDP, that would represent roughly $1.5 trillion of annual investment—broadly in line with estimates of where hyperscaler and artificial intelligence (AI)-related infrastructure spending could reach. Historically, these cycles have also been characterized by substantial increases in capital spending within the affected sectors as investment approached their peak.

These were not simply industry developments; they were large enough to influence economic growth, inflation, interest rates and financial markets.

The US expanded its rail network from roughly 35,000 miles following the Civil War to more than 250,000 miles by the early twentieth century. Household electrification increased from approximately 10% in 1910 to nearly 70% by 1930. During the Internet buildout, telecommunications companies invested hundreds of billions of dollars in fiber and communications infrastructure, much of which was later viewed as uneconomic following the technology bust. Yet the infrastructure remained. Global e-commerce, which measured only tens of billions of dollars annually in the late 1990s, now exceeds $6 trillion annually.

Investors often remember the excesses. History tends to remember the infrastructure. Large capital cycles often render previously correct assumptions obsolete.

This distinction matters because capital formation itself is not an investment thesis. We are interested in the consequences of that investment. Large capital cycles frequently shock industries, alter competitive positions and force market participants to abandon assumptions that may have been correct for years or even decades—this is the core of our philosophy and process. The resulting uncertainty, disagreement and occasional chaos often create substantial inefficiencies.

One of our longest held beliefs is that stubbornness is death with respect to investing. Markets evolve, industries change and competitive realities shift. Investors who remain anchored to a view of the world that no longer exists often struggle to adapt. By contrast, periods of significant change frequently create opportunities for investors who are willing to challenge prior assumptions and follow the evidence wherever it leads.

Today, we believe several meaningful capital formation cycles are occurring simultaneously.

The most visible is compute infrastructure. Aggregate capital expenditures among the largest hyperscalers are estimated to increase from approximately $146 billion in 2021 to nearly $900 billion by 2027. Global AI-related investment is approaching $1 trillion annually and continues to grow.

Beyond AI, capital alone cannot rapidly fix the damage done to the aerospace production infrastructure. Defense spending has reached record levels, domestic manufacturing investment has surged following a depression caused by globalization, and medical innovation continues to attract substantial research and development spending.

Simultaneously, one of the largest private capital formation cycles in history may be approaching public markets through companies such as SpaceX, Anthropic, Stripe and others, creating potential opportunities across the financial ecosystem responsible for financing, underwriting and allocating capital, colliding with a release of capital freedom driven by deregulation of US banks.

A True-Up of Our Investment Themes

The average holding period of our active investment themes through Q2 was approximately five years, and the underlying investments have changed far less than the labels we've used to describe them.

As capital formation reshapes the economy, we periodically update our thematic framework to ensure it reflects current economic reality. As a result, we renamed three themes, retired two and introduced a new theme. An overview of these changes is outlined in Exhibit 4.

Exhibit 4: Updated Thematic Framework

Old Theme	New Theme
Aerospace	Aerospace
Medical Innovations	Medical Innovations
De-Globalization	US Output
Transformation of the Enterprise	Compute Infrastructure
Data Monetization	Tech and Data Platforms
—	Evolving Financials
Digitization of User Experience & Commerce	Retired, Effective 1 Jul 2026
Network Infrastructure Modernization	Retired, Effective 1 Jul 2026

Source: Artisan Partners. As of 30 Jun 2026. Theme categorizations are at the sole discretion of the team. Themes and constituents are as of the date indicated and subject to change.

De-Globalization → US Output

"What began as disruption became a convergence of forces driving US productive capacity."

—Chris Smith

We introduced our De-Globalization theme in 2022 amid supply chain stress, geopolitics and energy insecurity. Capital shifted toward resilience: domestic production, energy security and industrial redundancy. That thesis played out—manufacturing construction doubled, semis accelerated, defense spending increased and industrial policy became a major capital driver. But the real outcome was not deglobalization—it was capacity rebuilding. The US' share of manufacturing fell from approximately 24% to approximately 16%, while investment lagged by roughly $270 billion annually, implying a $3 trillion gap. Energy, automation, AI infrastructure, defense and reshoring are now driving a sustained rebuild. We frame this as US Output.

Transformation of the Enterprise → Compute Infrastructure

"The theme was never solely about networks. It was about the physical infrastructure required to support the next generation of computing. Many of those forecasts proved directionally correct, but the scale of the opportunity evolved far beyond our original expectations."

—Chris Smith

We introduced Transformation of the Enterprise in 2020 to capture digital infrastructure demand. The scale that followed was entirely different. AI became a multi-trillion-dollar capital cycle. Token demand now exceeds 100 trillion per quarter and data center capacity has expanded more than 150% in a year. The constraint is no longer connectivity—it is computation. The opportunity expanded from networks into semiconductors, compute, power, cooling and AI infrastructure. We frame this as Compute Infrastructure.

Data Monetization → Tech and Data Platforms

Digital usage creates data. Data improves monetization. Better monetization increases usage. The loop compounds. Across payments, travel, financials, exchanges, entertainment, software and information services, the same structure now dominates. These businesses sit at the intersection of users, transactions and data. Scale improves data advantage. Data improves economics. Economics reinforce scale. We define this as Tech and Data Platforms.

Introducing Evolving Financials

Unlike the other theme changes discussed, Evolving Financials represents a new thematic category. The portfolio has already benefited in 2026, with strong Q2 contributions from Bank of New York Mellon and Goldman Sachs.

The foundation of the thesis is an observation borrowed from another part of the market.

Over the past several decades, many industrial businesses have transitioned from growth industries to mature industries. Globalization reduced domestic production growth, pricing power became more difficult to sustain, and management teams could no longer rely on favorable industry conditions to drive earnings growth. In response, industrial companies consolidated, rationalized capacity, improved capital allocation, reduced costs and became significantly better businesses.

Financials may be entering a similar phase, albeit several decades later.

For much of the post-global financial crisis period, the industry has operated under increasingly stringent regulatory requirements, elevated capital burdens and muted capital markets activity. Growth became more difficult to generate, forcing management teams to focus on efficiency, consolidation, cost reduction and capital discipline.

Today, conditions appear to be changing.

Capital markets activity, corporate lending and economic confidence are recovering from unusually depressed levels. At the same time, the regulatory pendulum appears to be swinging in the opposite direction. After years of increasingly punitive regulation, a more favorable regulatory environment has the potential to unlock excess capital, accelerate buybacks, improve lending activity and increase returns on equity across the industry.

Importantly, many financial institutions enter this period from a position of strength. Balance sheets are well capitalized; cost structures have been rationalized, and significant efficiency initiatives are already underway. Unlike prior cycles, financial companies are not being asked to improve their business models during the recovery. They initiated this work.

The result may be a rare setup where cyclical recovery and structural improvements are occurring simultaneously. We believe the combination of excess capital, improving capital markets activity, deregulation and continued operational efficiency creates the potential for sustained improvement in returns on capital, earnings power and growth expectations.

Ultimately, this is what attracted us to the opportunity. While the catalysts are unique to financials, the outcome appears familiar. Like many of our other themes, Evolving Financials is fundamentally a story about changing economics, improving returns on capital and an industry approaching an inflection point that may not yet be fully appreciated by the market.

Closing Thoughts

The common thread across the portfolio is change. We have continued to find opportunities where fundamentals were improving faster than expectations, driven by structural shifts rather than macro outcomes.

While we do not know where rates, inflation or policy will go, we do know that markets are the most inefficient during periods of transition, when the gap between perception and reality is widest. That is where we focus.

Importantly, many of the businesses we own are not in cyclical recovery—they are experiencing improving economics, whether through industrial rebuilding, accelerating AI and power investment or financial sector efficiency and capital return inflections.

The key distinction today is between passive and active exposure. Passive strategies increasingly concentrate risk in a small number of dominant securities. Our portfolio is built from the bottom up, independent of index weights and reflects only where we see improving fundamentals at the company level. As a result, we do not look like the index—and we do not try to. We own change, not composition. As such, we believe attaching our portfolio to a passive allocation has meaningful benefits for investors.

Volatility will persist. It always does. But volatility tied to structural change is where our process has historically generated the most value. We remain focused on that.

Thank you for your continued trust and partnership.

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Investment Results (%)

As of 30 June 2026	QTD	YTD	Average Annual Total Returns 1 Yr	3 Yr	5 Yr	10 Yr	Inception
Investor Class: ARTTX—Inception: 24 Apr 2017	**21.11**	**16.56**	**19.02**	**24.02**	**12.54**	**—**	**18.69**
Advisor Class: APDTX—Inception: 31 Jul 2018	**21.16**	**16.66**	**19.29**	**24.29**	**12.74**	**—**	**18.86**
Institutional Class: APHTX—Inception: 3 Feb 2020	**21.19**	**16.71**	**19.37**	**24.37**	**12.84**	**—**	**18.91**
S&P 500® Index	15.20	10.21	22.33	20.61	13.41	—	15.22

Source: Artisan Partners/S&P. Returns for periods less than one year are not annualized. For the period prior to inception, each of Advisor Class and Institutional Class's performance is the Investor Class's return for that period ("Linked Performance"). Linked Performance has not been restated to reflect expenses of the Advisor or Institutional Class and each share's respective returns during that period would be different if such expenses were reflected.

Past performance does not guarantee and is not a reliable indicator of future results. Investment returns and principal values will fluctuate so that an investor's shares, when redeemed, may be worth more or less than their original cost. Current performance may be lower or higher than that shown. Call 800.344.1770 for current to most recent month-end performance.

Expense Ratios (%)*

	ARTTX	APDTX	APHTX
Semi-Annual Report	1.36/—	1.14/—	1.05/—
Prospectus	1.36/—	1.15/—	1.07/—

*Unsubsidized/subsidized. Semi-annual Report: 31 Mar 2026. Prospectus: 30 Sep 2025. See prospectus for further details. Semi-Annual Report Figures: Unaudited, annualized for the six-month period.

Top 5 Issuers (% of net assets)

NVIDIA Corp	10.0
Apple Inc	9.2
Taiwan Semiconductor Manufacturing Co Ltd	7.5
Rolls-Royce Holdings PLC	7.4
Citizens Financial Group Inc	5.0
Total	**39.0%**

Carefully consider the Fund's investment objective, risks and charges and expenses. This and other important information is contained in the Fund's prospectus and summary prospectus, which can be obtained by calling 800.344.1770. Read carefully before investing.

Current and future portfolio holdings are subject to risk. The value of portfolio securities selected by the investment team may rise or fall in response to company, market, economic, political, regulatory or other news, at times greater than the market or benchmark index. A portfolio's environmental, social and governance ("ESG") considerations may limit the investment opportunities available and, as a result, the portfolio may forgo certain investment opportunities and underperform portfolios that do not consider ESG factors. Non-diversified portfolios may invest larger portions of assets in securities of a smaller number of issuers and performance of a single issuer may have a greater impact to the portfolio's returns. Use of derivatives may create investment leverage and increase the likelihood of volatility and risk of loss in excess of the amount invested. High portfolio turnover may adversely affect returns due to increased transaction costs and creation of additional tax consequences. Securities of small- and medium-sized companies tend to have a shorter history of operations, be more volatile and less liquid and may have underperformed securities of large companies during some periods. International investments involve special risks, including currency fluctuation, lower liquidity, different accounting methods and economic and political systems, and higher transaction costs. These risks typically are greater in emerging and less developed markets, including frontier markets.

S&P 500® Index measures the performance of 500 US companies focused on the large-cap sector of the market. **The S&P 500® Equal Weighted Index** gives each constituent the same weight in the index, versus the market weighted index where bigger companies hold a larger share of the index. **S&P 500® Top 20 Index** measures the performance of 20 of the largest, by float market cap, companies in the S&P 500® Index, rebalanced quarterly in March, June, September and December of each year. S&P 500® Top 20 Index inception: 1 Aug 2024. All information for the index prior to its inception date is hypothetical back-tested, not actual performance, based on the index methodology in effect on the inception date. Back-tested performance reflects application of an index methodology and selection of index constituents with the benefit of hindsight and knowledge of factors that may have positively affected its performance, cannot account for all financial risk that may affect results and may be considered to reflect survivor/look ahead bias. Actual returns may differ significantly from, and be lower than, back-tested returns. Past performance is not an indication or guarantee of future results. This back-tested data may have been created using a "Backward Data Assumption." The index(es) are unmanaged; include net reinvested dividends; do not reflect fees or expenses; and are not available for direct investment.

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Portfolio statistics are obtained from various data sources and intended to provide a general view of the portfolio, or Index, at a point in time. Artisan Partners excludes outliers when calculating portfolio characteristics and may use data from a related security to calculate statistics if information is unavailable for a particular security. Percent of net assets represents the portfolio's exposures based on the economic value of investments (including delta-adjusting options exposures). Delta-adjusted options exposure is a measure of the market exposure created by the options and accounts for the sensitivity of options to changes in price of the underlying security. In comparison, measuring the exposure of an option at the market value of the option or notional value can understate or overstate, respectively, the economic exposure and risk. This estimate of portfolio exposure is only an approximation of the portfolio at a point in time.

Contribution to Return (CTR) represents the contribution of an investment to the total portfolio return. CTR is calculated by multiplying a security's portfolio weight by its in-portfolio return daily for the period and has been derived from a transaction-based methodology, which includes the impact of transactions. **Attribution** quantifies the relationship between a portfolio's relative returns and the active management decisions differentiating the portfolio from the benchmark. **CTR and Attribution** are not exact, nor representative of actual investor returns due to several variables (e.g., fees, expenses, transactions) and therefore should be considered an approximation and examined in conjunction with the performance of the portfolio during the period. If applicable, securities of the same issuer are aggregated and may be delta-adjusted to determine the weight in the portfolio, and aggregation of corporate affiliates is subject to the determination of Artisan Partners. Further information on the methodology used is available upon request.

Theme classifications are at the sole discretion of the team. Themes and constituents are as of the date indicated and are subject to change. Certain holdings have been reclassified subsequent to initial investment, which has impacted theme performance during the period. Portfolio sector classifications are defined by the investment team based on GICS.

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Alpha is a quantitative measure of the volatility of the portfolio relative to a designated index. A positive alpha of 1.0 means the fund has outperformed its designated index by 1%. Correspondingly, a similar negative alpha would indicate an underperformance of 1%. **Upward Revisions** represent positive changes to previous earnings estimates or earnings forecast and indicate a more positive or increased outlook for the company, portfolio or index. **Earnings Per Share (EPS)** is the portion of a company's profit allocated to each outstanding share of common stock. **Return on invested capital (ROIC)** is a calculation used to assess a company's efficiency in allocating capital to profitable investments. **Weighted Average Cost of Capital (WACC)** represents the blended cost a company pays for its capital, averaging the cost of equity and after-tax debt, weighted by their proportions in the company's capital structure. **Correlation** is a statistical measure of how two securities move in relation to each other. A perfect positive correlation is represented by the value +1.00, while 0.00 indicates no correlation and -1.00 indicates a perfect negative correlation. **R-Squared (R^2)** indicates the proportionate amount of variation in the dependent variable that is explained by the independent variable, measured on a scale of 0.0-1.0. **Earnings Growth Rate** is the annual rate at which a company's earnings are expected to grow. Implied Volatility is a forward-looking measure showing the market's expectation of how much an asset's price will fluctuate in the future, derived from current options prices. **Standard Deviation** defines how widely returns varied from an average over a given period of time. Higher deviation represents higher volatility. **Forward Earnings** are an estimate of the next period's earnings of a company, usually until the completion of the current fiscal year and sometimes to the following fiscal year. **Capital Expenditures (Capex)** represents the funds used to purchase, maintain or upgrade assets, such as buildings, equipment, infrastructure, computer hardware and other tangible property. **Earnings Power** is a figure that telegraphs a business's ability to generate profits over the long term, assuming all current operational conditions generally remain constant.

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